Yixin Liu

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Areas of Expertise

Topics: Collaborative governance, environmental policy, local government
Methods: Causal inference with experimental and observational data, geospatial modeling

Academic Appointments

Baruch College, City University of New York
Assistant Professor, Marxe School of Public & International Affairs 2025-
Northern Arizona University
Assistant Professor, Department of Politics & International Affairs 2024-2025
Syracuse University
Post-doctoral Scholar, Maxwell School of Citizenship & Public Affairs 2022-2024

Education

Florida State University
Ph.D. Askew School of Public Administration 2017-2022
Rutgers University-New Brunswick
M.P.P. Bloustein School of Planning and Public Policy 2014-2016
Hong Kong Baptist University
B.A. in Advertising 2009-2013

Peer-Reviewed Articles

10. **Yixin Liu**, Jiho Kim, Tina Nabatchi (2026) A "watershed" moment for collaboration: The impacts of legislation and network governance on environmental outcomes. *Public Administration Review*, 86(2): 414–429.
    - Media coverage: "Collaborative governance in action: Oregon's watershed restoration success," *Public Management*, ICMA, September 2026.
9. Guimin Zheng, Heewon Lee, Wenhui Li, **Yixin Liu**, Tian Tang (2026) Navigating the algorithmic state: Public values and citizens' preferences of AI-driven public service delivery. *Public Administration.*

8. Wenhui Li, Heewon Lee, **Yixin Liu**, Tian Tang, Guimin Zheng (2025) Reward exploitation or exploration? The effects of local government sustainability strategies and performance information on citizen evaluation. *Public Management Review*, 27(12): 3057–3078.
7. **Yixin Liu** (2024) Partisan collaboration in policy adoption: An experimental study with local government officials. *Policy Studies Journal*, 52(4): 955–967.
   - China-America Association for Public Affairs *Best Student Paper Award for 2022*
   - Media coverage by *Art of Science*
6. Heewon Lee and **Yixin Liu*** (2024) All hands on deck: The role of collaborative platforms and lead organizations in achieving environmental goals. *Journal of Public Administration Research & Theory*, 34(3), 331-348. [*co-first author]
   - "Honorable mention" of the APSA *Herbert Kaufman Best Paper Award for 2024*
   - Selected as the "JPART editor's choice" article
5. **Yixin Liu** (2024) Public trust and collaborative governance: An instrumental variable approach. *Public Management Review*, 26(2), 421-442.
4. **Yixin Liu** and Chao Tan (2023) The effectiveness of network administrative organizations in governing inter-jurisdictional natural resources. *Public Administration*, 101(3), 932-952.
3. **Yixin Liu**, Heewon Lee, Frances Berry (2023) How and when democratic values matter: Challenging the effectiveness-centric framework in program evaluation. *Public Performance & Management Review*, 1-26.
   - Florida State University *de Guzman Best Graduate Paper Award for 2021*
2. **Yixin Liu*** and Chengxin Xu (2023) De-stereotyping public performance evaluation. *International Public Management Journal*, 26(1), 107-125. [*co-first author]
1. Chengxin Xu and **Yixin Liu** (2021) Does mislabeling COVID-19 elicit the perception of threat and reduce blame? *Journal of Behavioral Public Administration*, 4(2).

Selected Working Projects

Danyao Li, **Yixin Liu**, Chengxin Xu, Guimin Zheng. Public pressure expands policy access for black constituents but limits substantive engagement. *Revise & Resubmit.*

Jiho Kim, **Yixin Liu**, Yoon-Jung Choi. Turning policy outputs into outcomes in collaborative governance. *Revise & Resubmit.*

Yixin Liu, Heewon Lee, Tian Tang, Wenhui Li, Guimin Zheng. Government trust and participation in collaborative planning: Paired experiments on citizens and policymakers. *Under Review.*

Joanne Kim, Jiho Kim, **Yixin Liu**, Tina Nabatchi. From framework to instrument: Developing and validating scales for collaborative governance. *Under Review.*

Jiho Kim and **Yixin Liu**. Outcomes of outcomes: Adaptations of collaborative actions in watershed management. *Under Review.*

Yixin Liu, Tian Tang, Heewon Lee. Legitimacy in and out: Why local governments collaborate with researchers and how citizens respond.

Yixin Liu and Tian Tang. Watching big brothers: Can nonprofit oversight mitigate environmental injustice?

Joanne Kim, **Yixin Liu**, Catherine Gerard, Rosemary O'Leary. Local government collaboration in the U.S.: What's changed over a decade?

Yixin Liu, Chengxin Xu, Weijie Wang. Is causal inference "observable" in public administration? A systematic review.

Ivan Lee, **Yixin Liu**, Sebastian Jilke. Reassessing anti-public sector bias: Evidence from a comprehensive experiment and meta analysis.

Grants and Awards

PSC-CUNY Research Award, ($7,000)	2026
Marxe School Dean's Research Release from Teaching Award	2026
APSA Paul Volcker Junior Scholar Research Grant (1st Place Winner), ($3,000)	2024
Best Student Paper Award, China-America Association for Public Affairs	2022
DeGuzman Best Paper Award, Florida State University	2021
UROP Materials Grant, Principal Investigator, Florida State University, ($500)	2021
Reubin Askew Eminent Research Fund, Florida State University, ($850)	2020
Reubin Askew Educational Endowment Fund, Florida State University, ($1,500)	2020
Jerry Collins Eminent Research Fund, Florida State University, ($650)	2019
ICPSR Travel Grant, Florida State University, ($5,000)	2019
Travel Grant, National Social-Environmental Synthesis Center, ($500)	2019
Dean's Scholarship, Florida State University	2017

Invited Talks

"Is causal inference 'observable' in public administration?"	2026
Doctoral Colloquium at Florida State University	
"Adaptive strategies for collaborative watershed management"	2026
4th Annual Baruch College Conference on Climate	
"How to prepare for job interviews"	2025
CAAPA, CPSG, ESCN, SCPA Joint Job Workshop Series	
"Making a plan for your PhD"	2025
Doctoral Colloquium at Florida State University	
"Experimental methods in social science"	2024
Summer Methods Camp at Huazhong University of Science and Technology	
"Governing inter-jurisdictional natural resources and environmental policy analysis"	2023
Guangdong Research Institute of Water Resources and Hydropower	
"Public trust and collaborative governance"	2023

Public Management Community

"Research in public administration: A seminar of contributions from Chinese scholars." 2022
Public Administration Journal

"Governing inter-jurisdictional rivers" 2021
Online Seminar on Environmental Politics and Governance

Conference Presentations

Public Management Research Conference	2019, 2021, 2022, 2024-2026
Association for Public Policy Analysis & Management	2018-2021, 2023-2026
American Political Science Association	2023, 2024
American Society for Public Administration	2022
Southern Political Science Association	2020
European Group for Public Administration	2020
Sino-US International Conference of Public Administration	2018, 2021

Teaching

Baruch College, The City University of New York

PAF 9120 Public and Nonprofit Management	Graduate level
PAF 9140 Budgeting and Financial Analysis	Graduate level
PAF 1250 Citizenship and Public Affairs	Undergraduate level

Northern Arizona University

POS 544 Government Budgeting	Graduate level
POS 535 Regulatory Process	Graduate level
POS 359 Environmental Policy	Undergraduate level

Florida State University

PAD 3003 Public Administration in American Society	Undergraduate level

Journal Referee

Chinese Public Administration Review; Environmental Management; Environmental Policy and Governance; Environmental Politics; International Journal of Public Administration; Journal of Behavioral Public Administration; Journal of Environmental Policy and Planning; Journal of Policy Analysis and Management; Journal of Public Administration Research & Theory; *Nature*: Humanities and Social Sciences Communications; *Nature*: Scientific Reports; Policy & Politics; Public Administration; Public Administration Review; Public Choice; Public Management Review; Public Performance & Management Review; Regulation & Governance; Review of Public Personnel Administration; Urban Governance